VALERIIA KULAKOVA

AI PRODUCT BUILDER · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER

CONTACT

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PROFILE

AI product builder with a background in software engineering and agile delivery. Almost five years in agile IT projects as a developer, Scrum Master and proxy product owner. What interests me most is the step between requirement and release: turning what a team decides to build into something people enjoy using. I work with AI tools across research, design and code.

SKILLS

- *Product & Agile:* Backlog management, prioritization, user stories with acceptance criteria, MVP scoping, stakeholder alignment, facilitating Scrum events
- UX & Research: User interviews, surveys, story mapping, user flows, prototyping
- *Tech:* Web applications, REST APIs, SQL, cloud (AWS, Azure), CI/CD
- *Tools:* Jira, Azure DevOps, Confluence, Figma, Miro, NotebookLM, Perplexity, Claude

LANGUAGES

- German: C1
- English: B2
- Ukrainian: Native

EXPERIENCE

Product Ownership & Product Design Training
01/2026 - Present

- Self-study in product ownership and UX until 07/2026, then product design bootcamp at Digitale Leute School (08-12/2026)
- End-to-end product design of ReSway, a routine app that helps people with ADHD restart routines after a break
- In-depth interviews, a survey (14 participants) and competitive analysis, synthesized into an affinity map, personas, journey map
- How Might We questions, MVP scoped with a story map, from lo-fi wireframes to an interactive hi-fi prototype in Figma
- Iterated after usability tests (2 participants), defined success KPIs, built a design system with WCAG contrast

Scrum Master & Requirements Engineer
Materna Information & Communications SE | 02/2023 - 12/2025

- Proxy product owner for an internal HR matching tool that uses GenAI to analyze consultant profiles and match them to client projects
- Translated the department head's requirements into user stories and aligned the technical setup with the development team, from profile PDF upload to the planned HR system integration
- Introduced tracking of planned vs. actual story points, which led to rules for more realistic sprint planning and for splitting large stories
- Facilitated all Scrum events for a team of nine, onboarded new team members and led conversations to resolve conflicts
- Wrote user stories for an energy-sector client project and contributed to client proposals covering delivery approach, technology stack and implementation plan

Software Developer
Materna Information & Communications SE | 04/2021 - 06/2023
Also Scrum Master from February 2023 (approx. 30%)

- Web and backend development in a trainee project (Kotlin, React) and a logistics client project (C#/.NET, Angular)
- Contributed to cloud migrations on AWS
- Ensured quality through unit and E2E tests and code reviews
- Wrote and maintained technical documentation and managed data with SQL

Work-Study Student, Business Information Systems
Ledvance GmbH | 10/2017 - 02/2021

- Automated traffic reports that informed product page optimization in e-commerce
- Prepared migration options (SAP S/4HANA, Oracle) as input for management decisions
- Developed a Python application to analyze sensor data

EDUCATION

Bachelor's in Business Information Systems
Rosenheim Technical University of Applied Sciences | 10/2017 - 02/2021

- Focus on requirements engineering and UML modeling
- Bachelor's thesis: “Brand Recognition on TikTok Using Deep Learning”, grade 1.5 (German scale, 1.0 is best)

Studies in Business Administration
Kharkiv State University of Food Technology and Trade | 09/2014 - 08/2016